GMS WEEKLY

Your Source for Recycling News

January 30th, 2026
Week 5
Volume 280, Issue 1221

Highlights:

- **Debbie Downer.**
- **India secures.**
- **Supply slow.**
- **Challenges.**
- **HKC gains.**
- **Scan to download / view the Weekly on the GMS App!**

QUOTE of the WEEK

"Tomorrow is the first blank page of a 365-page book. Write a good one."

– Brad Paisley

-- MARKET COMMENTARY --

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AND JUST LIKE THAT…

… January 2026 joins the pages of history as being the purveyors of ongoing misery for the global ship recycling world as despite the odd wave of tonnage that has made us numb to the conflicting signals of the markets based on supply trends across the last 5 years, something eye-catching did change this week. And it would seem that the rising ripples from Trump's train wreck of activity has posed global markets to setup a serious "Debbie Downer" for February 2026, especially if the current trends persist.

To start, we have noteworthy surges to report this week. Across the board, for most of the major fundamentals, except sub-continent steel plate prices that have become the perennial party poopers of the recycling world of late, the momentum was definitely beyond noticeable. The Baltic Exchange Dry Index, oil futures, and the U.S. Dollar collectively soared this week, creating ripples that would certainly be felt within the next 4 weeks. While the dry index soared 7.3% on the back of Capes pole-vaulting 12%, Panamaxes tripping up 1.6% in comparison, and Supras having a comparatively minor hiccup gain of 0.5%, oil futures impressively slid past USD 65/barrel and close the week out at USD 65.10 – a near 1% jump from last week.

And the U.S. Dollar's performance across the ship recycling markets was reminiscent of Marilyn Monroe's infamous wavy skirt subway photo, the wavy lines capturing just how volatile Trump has made global financial markets on the back of further tariff threats against Canada, nation states in Europe including France and Denmark, and even striking into the hearts of global ship recycling markets with Pakistan (surprisingly) taking the biggest of hits this week. Speaking of the ship recycling markets, they certainly seem to be having a global "up" moment, with India, Pakistan Bangladesh and Turkey **all** reportedly picking up some long overdue tonnage, although only India Bangladesh and Turkish anchorages are delivering the receipts to confirm these fixtures. India managed to even secure an LNG for strictly HKC recycling only and Turkey with its bevy of roros and "buffet-full bellies" confirming that all of the major ship recycling destinations collectively secured their share of available market vessels since the start of January 2026 (and in a long time).

Yet, the performances of the various dry indices stand to support the general expectation that supply will more than likely slow further down as we head into the traditionally quieter Chinese New Year period / warmer months, and as a variety of geopolitical and financial shocks are expected to arrive in February, including the critical elections in Bangladesh, an INR that's consistently breaking its own depreciation records (now firmly in the 90s against the U.S. Dollar), and an urgent need to speed up HKC transitions across the Gadani shoreline in order to be ready when tonnage actually starts flowing in, Q1 2026 certainly stands critical. Notwithstanding, there was still some good news which came through this week as another yard in Gadani reportedly received the country's first NK HKC approval after significant hard work, investment and the requisite infrastructure upgrades.

GMS market rankings / pricing for week 5 of 2026 are on Page 6.

BANGLADESH

BACK TO BIZ?

Securing cape.

After missing out on several vessels to sub-continent rivals (including an LNG to India and several panamax sized bulkers seemingly into Pakistan), it was certainly good to see Bangladeshi buyers get back in on the action at the bidding tables with the only reported capesize bulker acquisition of the week, and that reportedly too at decent levels, an oddity considering Bangladesh's overstuffed and digestive state just last week.

22 HKC yards.

And as purchases were grabbing the headlines at the waterfront, political headlines continue to grab the news inlands across the country, especially now with January passed and the nation's landmark elections - the first in 2 years - standing just 2 weeks away. It has certainly been a long time coming for the country to finally find a modicum of political and economic stability, even if it potentially stands to be short-lived (just as the last election was), and given how much the nation has clearly struggled under the currently dysfunctional regime over the last 20 months, they are hopefully on their collective way out.

Landmark elections.

What has also been short-lived is Chattogram's dance with an empty port position as clearly this week, several tankers of varying LDTs greeted the waterfront with one even being promptly delivered to its respective new owner already. News of the lowly local resale prices on some of the smaller tankers are emerging as well, with one reportedly achieving a meager USD 330/LT, hence the surprise at the reportedly firm price on this week's reported acquisition.

Fundamentally, things look like they make solid pricing moves (at least in early February) a near uncertainty given the ongoing performance of local steel plate prices (currently dead on the floor for at least 2 weeks running), which are stranded at USD 487.24/ton. Add into the pricing cocktail, some spicy Tabasco of Bangladeshi Taka, which fell 1% this week and closed it out at BDT 122.95 against the U.S. Dollar, it seems like next week might be back to the pricing board for local buyers, before making any rash purchases in the immediate future.

Tick tock.

Overall, with 22 yards (and counting) that now stand HKC approved, it has been encouraging to see some fierce bidding on HKC only tonnage (particularly LNGs) being offered to approved Chattogram yards. And his becomes even critical whenever the supply of green tonnage ramps up (tick tock reality, its 2026 already).

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

INDIA

RABID RUPEE!

The Indian Rupee has had a fundamental (pun intended) earthquake on an economic scale as it plummeted another 25 basis points by week's end, and after briefly surging to Rs. 92.18 against the U.S. Dollar – currently still in excess of Rs. 93 for non-regulatory Dollar purchases (i.e. for regular people) – it closed shop for the weekend at Rs. 91.82.

Belly jiggle.

Local steel plate prices added their own belly jiggle to this week's entertainment as it fell to nearly USD 398/Ton before recovering to a – still lower than last week - level of about USD 401/Ton, dictating the destiny of upcoming offer levels in the coming week. And as is typical of the nervy Indian sentiment, amidst the perplexing historical lows seen in the performance of INR, of course we saw fears that the currency may even breach Rs. 100 against U.S. Dollar, ensuring future acquisitions get ever so dicier!

Damp demand.

Ironically however, while on the one hand, this clearly placed a dampener on prevailing sentiments and demand, manifesting itself into the current state of local offerings that have ensured India remains at the bottom of the sub-continent pricing board, on the other hand, Alang was and has been the busiest of all anchorages as nearly 47K LDT via 6 vessels (including another large LDT tanker) earmarked the nation's ship recycling waterfront this week.

Cannot compete.

But, as recycling nation currencies across the board have reacted negatively and in unison to the U.S. Dollar this week, could we see the same level of pullback from competing markets in the coming week(s) now that as Pakistan and Bangladesh have had their chance to stay notably ahead over these last couple of weeks? Crystall ball moment.

What is however certain, is that with another Pakistani yard not snagging a Class NK pedigree HKC approval in Gadani, the triangular see-saw of sub-continent ship recycling is about to get really interesting in the months and years ahead.

Triangular seesaw.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

PAKISTAN

SECOND HKC UP!

Iranian halt.

That's not a "second hiccup" folks and you read that right. Gadani's HKC recycling momentum has now welcomed a Class NK approved HKC certified ship recycling yard to its gradually growing collection, with Salams International now becoming the nation's second ship recycling yard to earn this prestigious certification.

And while this will certainly challenge neighboring Alang's purchasing prowess as time progresses, it truly welcomes Gadani's infrastructure into the international arena and will hopefully generate greater confidence towards the nation's industry.

Importing dry.

Meanwhile, local steel plate prices, like those in Bangladesh, seem to be experiencing their own lights-out moment as they remained horizontal for the week, albeit at an industry-leading USD 587/ton. But after weeks of flaunting its stabilizing (and even firming) ability, it was the Pakistani Rupee that took home the attention of the industry, declining by about 1.4% and wrapping up the week at nearly PKR 282 once again.

In the interim (and reportedly), several decent sized bulker sales (largely handymax and panamax sized) have taken place to local buyers, as a result of Pakistan's comparatively firmer offerings than India, and there is still a growing desire to import more vessels – particularly evident this week during a bidding contest over a capesize bulker for recycling.

Right time.

Overall, slow and steady gains mixed in with better late than never is what the Gadani Gang seems to be prodigiously on, and with the timing of supply, the clock might just show the right time for Gadani soon enough.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

TURKEY

DEMAND AND LIRA…

After the recent entry of a batch of roros into Aliaga of late, demand (and hunger) for tonnage is on the rise, including the rise of the U.S. Dollar against the Turkish Lira that too ended the week 26 basis points weaker, at TRY 43.50, merrily on their way to greet TRY 44.

Merrily.

Moderate fluctuations in import steel levels aside, there really isn't much to report from Turkey this week.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

GMS Weekly – Market Rankings

For Week 5 of 2026, GMS Market Rankings / vessel indications are as below.

Rank	Location	Sentiment	Dry Bulk USD / LDT	Tankers USD / LDT	Containers USD / LDT
1	Pakistan	**Improving**	420 / LDT	440 / LDT	450 / LDT
2	Bangladesh	**Steady**	410 / LDT	430 / LDT	440 / LDT
3	India	**Steady**	400 / LDT	420 / LDT	430 / LDT
4	Turkey	**Steady**	270 / LDT	280 / LDT	290 / LDT

ANOTHER…2025 IN REVIEW!!

- *Jan 03: 17-year-old darts prodigy Luke Littler became the youngest-ever World Darts Champion.*
- *Jan 20: Donald Trump was inaugurated as the 47th President of the United States of America.*
- *Jan 27: Nvidia stocks fell by $588.8 billion after the release of Chinese AI model DeepSeek.*
- *Jan 29: A US Army helicopter crashed into a commercial jet during night training near D.C., killing all 67 on board.*
- *Feb 08: Chen Ying-chu won Taiwan's first-ever medal at the Asian Winter Games in speed skating.*
- *Feb 10: World leaders from over 100 countries gathered in Paris to discuss and promote the responsible development of AI.*
- *Feb 15: A gold-mine collapse near Kéniéba in Mali killed 42 people and injured several others.*
- *Feb 25: A nationwide blackout in Chile left over 90% of the country without power.*
- *Mar 02: Firefly Aerospace's Blue Ghost became the first commercial lander to make a successful soft landing on the Moon.*
- *Mar 09: For the first time, a colossal squid was captured on video in its natural habitat.*
- *Mar 14: Canada swore in Mark Carney as its new Prime Minister, ending 9 years of Justin Trudeau's rule.*
- *Mar 26: Masaki Kashiwara became Japan's first mathematician to win math's greatest award.*
- *Apr 02: Scientists unveiled a pacemaker as small as a grain of rice.*
- *Apr 05: Inventors of the weight loss drugs Ozempic and Wegovy were awarded the $3 million Breakthrough Prize.*
- *Apr 07: Asia-Pacific stock markets experienced their largest decline in decades after Trump announced tariffs of up to 46%.*
- *Apr 16: Chess grandmaster Ju Wenjun won her fifth Women's World Chess Championship title in a row.*

IMPORTANT DATES

INDIA	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
No holidays in February	January 30 – February 06 February 16 – February 23

BANGLADESH	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
February 11 – General Holiday February 12 – Election Holiday February 21 – Martyr's Day	February 03 – February 06 February 19 – February 22

BANK HOLIDAYS	
PAKISTAN	**TURKEY**
February 05 – Kashmir Solidarity Day February 18 – Bank Holiday	**No holidays in February**

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ALANG - Port Position as of January 30, 2026

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	*Global Star (Under Tow)*	*4,237*	*Oil Tanker*	*Delivered January 25*
2	Olga L	3,734	Reefer	Arrived January 24
3	Rising Harrier	8,553	Bulk Carrier	Arrived January 25
4	Woodchip	22,800	Oil Tanker	Arrived January 29
5	*Yong Ang*	*6,057*	*Reefer*	*Delivered January 30*
6	Yun Da You 6	1,139	Oil Tanker	Arrived January 20
Morality		**46,520**		

CHATTOGRAM - Port Position as of January 30, 2026

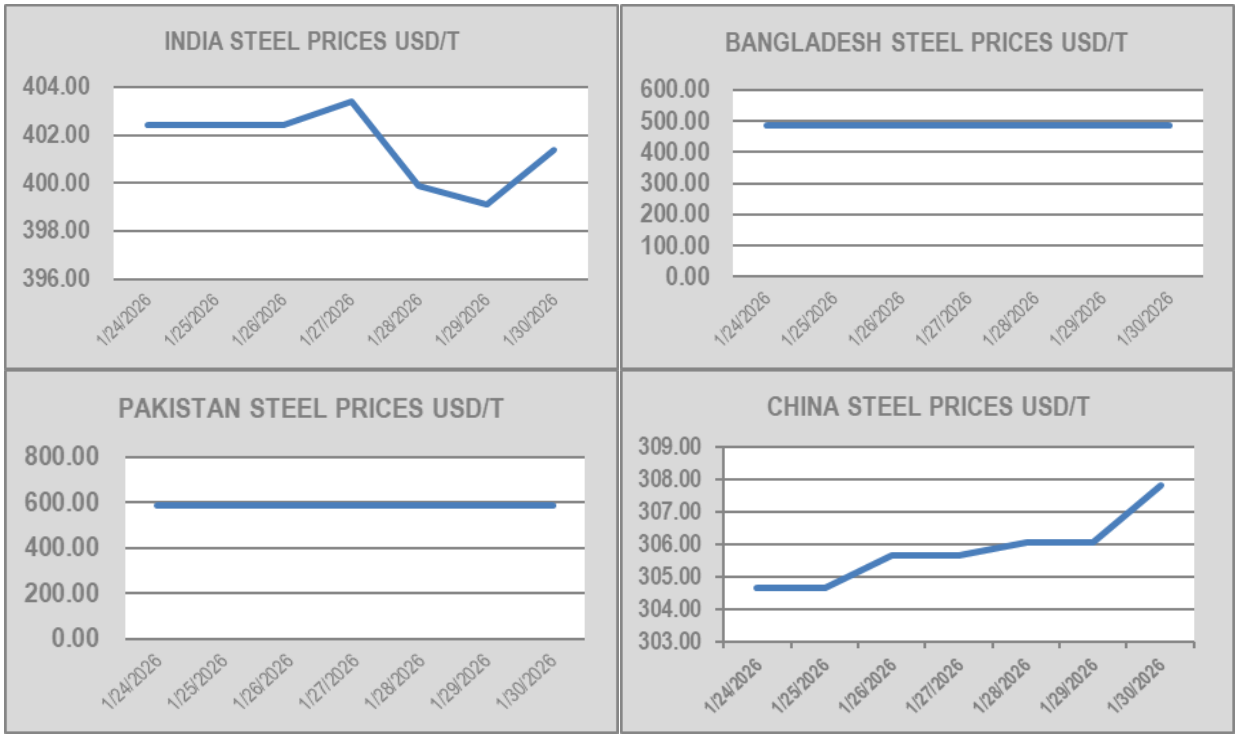
No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Fuji	950	Tanker	Arrived January 29
2	Hakata	354	Tanker	Arrived January 29
3	Hong Li	6,132	Bulk Carrier	Arrived January 24
4	Kohzan Maru	9,963	Tanker	*Delivered January 26*
		17,398		

GADANI - Port Position as of January 30, 2026

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
		No new vessels reported.		
Total Tonnage		**-**		

WHILE EXTREME CARE HAS BEEN TAKEN IN THE PREPARATION OF THIS REPORT, NO LIABILITY CAN BE ACCEPTED FOR ANY LOSS INCURRED IN ANY WAY WHATSOEVER BY ANY PERSON RELYING ON THE INFORMATION CONTAINED HEREIN.

DATE	INDIA STEEL PRICES USD/T	INDIA STEEL PRICES	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES USD/T	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES USD/T	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES	CHINA STEEL PRICES USD/T
1/24/2026	402.44	37,000.00	586.98	165,000.00	487.24	59,200.00	304.66
1/25/2026	402.44	37,000.00	586.98	165,000.00	487.24	59,200.00	304.66
1/26/2026	402.44	37,000.00	586.98	165,000.00	487.24	59,200.00	305.69
1/27/2026	403.40	37,000.00	586.98	165,000.00	487.24	59,200.00	305.69
1/28/2026	399.87	36,700.00	586.98	165,000.00	487.24	59,200.00	306.07
1/29/2026	399.13	36,700.00	586.98	165,000.00	487.24	59,200.00	306.07
1/30/2026	401.39	36,900.00	586.98	165,000.00	487.24	59,200.00	307.84



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